

MILIND SHELTE

A Higher Calling

AT TISS, THE PANDEMIC BROUGHT NO PAUSE IN THE PURSUIT OF INNOVATIVE TEACHING METHODOLOGIES. IN FACT, IT LED TO MORE INTERNATIONAL COLLABORATIONS

By Suhani Singh

Bozo and Bisleri are thrilled. After 18 months of no activity, the sylvan campus of the Tata Institute of Social Sciences (TISS) in Deonar, Mumbai, is buzzing. Finally, the hallways are filled with students whom the two dogs can lick, play with and ask for treats. Christso Kamkra from Imphal is one of them. Early this year, when he and Themreiso Awungshi learned that they would finally get to attend an offline class even if it was only for a month, the two Manipuri students were thrilled. Classes for most of their two-year programme were held online. "The bonds forged online were bereft of emotion and not quite helpful. It's only when I came here that we made lots of friends," says Awungshi. Prachi Bhelane from Gondia district in Maharashtra called this batch "the most resilient". "There were lots of challenges, but we made the most of it," she says. Nearly 70 per cent of the latest batch of 173 graduates got a variety of jobs—from corporate social responsibility programmes of Hero Motor Corp, Deloitte, ICICI Foundation to NGOs like Eklavya, Meljol and Pradan.

TOP 10 SOCIAL WORK COLLEGES

RANK 2022	RANK 2021	COLLEGE
1	1	TATA INSTITUTE OF SOCIAL SCIENCES (TISS), Mumbai
2	2	RAJAGIRI COLLEGE OF SOCIAL SCIENCES (AUTONOMOUS), Kochi
3	3	DEPARTMENT OF SOCIAL WORK, DELHI SCHOOL OF SOCIAL WORK, UNIVERSITY OF DELHI, New Delhi
4	4	MADRAS SCHOOL OF SOCIAL WORK, Chennai
5	5	COLLEGE OF SOCIAL WORK (AUTONOMOUS), NIRMALA NIKETAN, Mumbai
6	7	DEPARTMENT OF SOCIAL WORK, LOYOLA COLLEGE OF SOCIAL SCIENCES, Thiruvananthapuram
7	6	DEPARTMENT OF SOCIAL WORK, CHRIST (DEEMED TO BE UNIVERSITY), Bengaluru
8	9	DEPARTMENT OF SOCIAL WORK, LOYOLA COLLEGE (AUTONOMOUS), Chennai
9	10	FACULTY OF SOCIAL WORK, MAHARAJA SAYAJIRAO UNIVERSITY OF BARODA, Vadodara
10	8	DEPARTMENT OF SOCIAL WORK, MADRAS CHRISTIAN COLLEGE, Chennai